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TENURE	CAME FROM	SEARCH	HOT SIGNAL
14 months at Westfield	Tier-1 enterprise software search firm	VP Product, Helios Compliance Systems	Cited NorthBay Trust in initial outreach

SNAPSHOT

Westfield-side owner of a confidential VP Product search at Helios Compliance Systems, a long-held PE portfolio company in mid-AI-productization arc. Surfaced your NorthBay Trust tenure in initial outreach, signaling cross-portfolio operating fluency is on the rubric. This screen is about storyline coherence and pattern fit; substance comes with the hiring manager and operating partner later.

FOUR TELLS THAT SHAPE HOW THEY'LL HEAR YOU

- 1 First Westfield impression, not the hiring manager's.** Job is to qualify storyline, level, portfolio fit, and "why now." Frame for narrative, not technical depth.
- 2 Pre-pattern-matched your NorthBay tenure.** Already pre-sold on the cross-portfolio operating fluency angle. Confirm; don't oversell.
- 3 Inclusive-recruiting orientation runs through history.** Distributed-team and inclusive-hiring evidence will land. You have it (US, EU, India teams).
- 4 Treat as peer, not gatekeeper.** Will be deferential to the OP's read but confident in own screen. Don't drop names; will be spotted.

THE STRATEGIC MOMENT

What Taylor is recruiting against at Helios

- Westfield has held Helios since 2018; long hold, value-creation chapter underway.
- AI-assisted workflow adoption jumped 6x YoY; AI is the central narrative.
- First international add-on closed Q2; post-merger integration unfinished.
- Co-founder CPO/CIO carries dual hat; VP Product is operational lieutenant.

FIVE CONVERSATION HOOKS (IN ORDER)

- 1 Lead with cross-portfolio operating fluency.**
"NorthBay and Helios were in commercial relationship before Westfield owned Helios; the founder was an early angel and NorthBay was a customer. I came up inside the Westfield thesis on the regulated-data side."
- 2 Five-acquisition integration parallel.**
The new add-on is Helios's first cross-border integration. You led product diligence and PMI on five at NorthBay, including AI/ML capability mapping. Precise match.
- 3 Customer-facing AI in regulated environments.**
Same pattern Helios is running with AI scoring, Agent Studio, Trust Center. You've already done the AI-meets-regulated-buyer translation problem.
- 4 The 6x AI adoption data point as a probe.**
"That kind of curve usually means either the product caught up to demand or customers are now feeling the trust ceiling. Where is the team focused next?"
- 5 Distributed-team operating cadence.**
Helios runs four global offices; you ran 12 PMs and 119 engineers across three time zones with sustained EU-India overlap. State as a fact, not a brag.

WHAT TO AVOID · WHAT TO USE

- AVOID**
- Naming Westfield execs unprompted; product theory jargon; "I've done all this before"; negative framing of last role; over-formatted answers.

- Trust Center, Agent Studio, AI scoring framework are the three product anchors.

USE "Westfield operating model"; "category leadership"; "EBITDA-aware roadmap"; "post-merger product convergence"; "player-coach"; concrete numbers.

CLOSE WITH (PICK ONE)

Q. What does your process look like from here, and who do I see next?

Standard process question; get the shape clear.

Q. What separates the Westfield-portfolio operators who succeed in a cross-portfolio move from the ones who don't quite land?

Surfaces real screening criteria.

Q. If you put yourself in the CPO's chair on day 90, what is the one capability gap on the current product team that would make this hire feel like a clear win?

The high-leverage one. Will outlive the call and get repeated upstream.

SAMPLE OUTPUT · FICTIONAL SCENARIO FOR ILLUSTRATION

Confirm fit; don't audition. The firm already has a thesis on you.